CQU

Social Work Field Education Manual

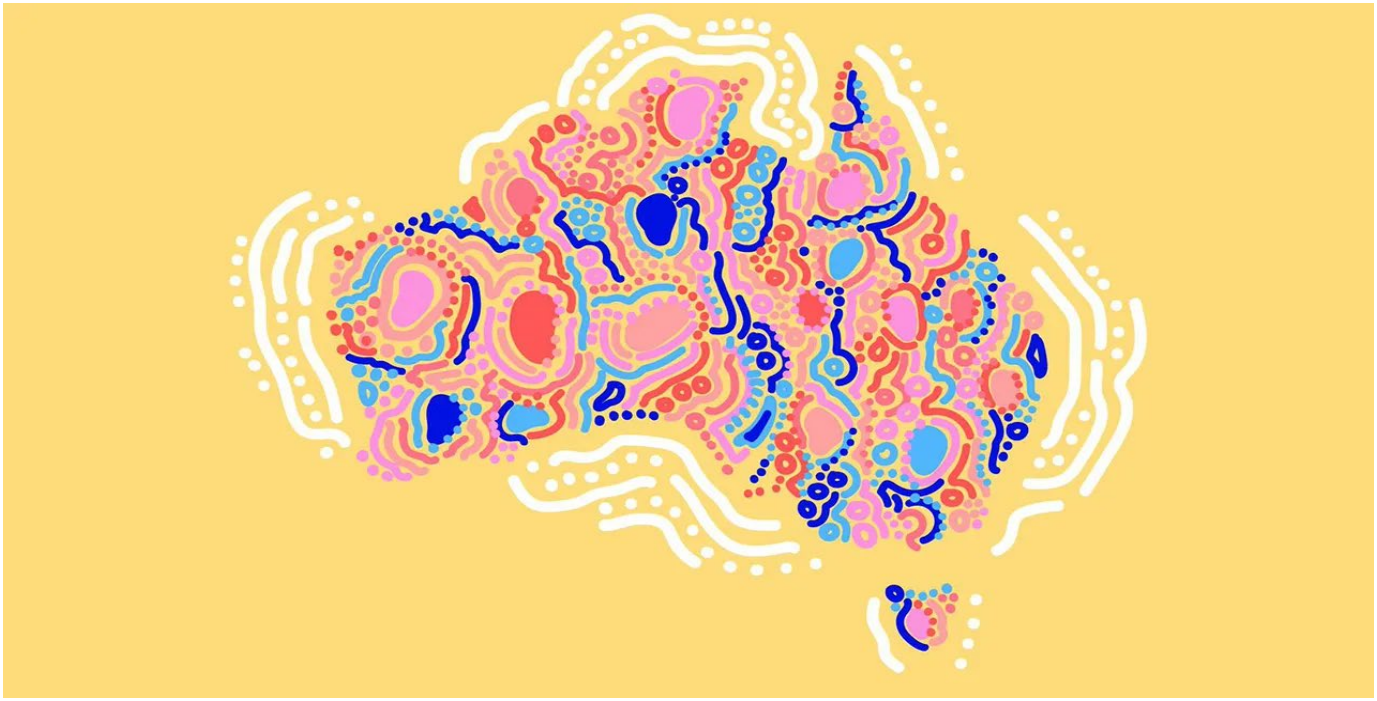
SOWK13009
Field Education 1
&
SOWK14009
Field Education 2



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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF COUNTRY



We respectfully acknowledge the Traditional Custodians of the lands and seas on which we work, learn, and play, and pay respect to the First Nations Peoples and their Elders, past, present, and future.

Field Education Team's Contact details:

Field Education Team – regarding all social work field education specific queries –

Email: fieldeducation@cqu.edu.au

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WELCOME

Welcome to the CQUni Fieldwork Education Manual which will guide you through the process and experience of embarking on your first field education experience.

Field education is an important part of your degree, this is where all the learning from the past two years gets put into practice – in a safe and supported way, where you are supervised and assisted to make your first steps as a social worker in training.

CQUni commits to offering students:

- An **anti-oppressive education** where relationships between students and staff are more akin to organisational practice than lecturers and students in theatres or classrooms;
- Respect for **human diversity** resulting in many modes of educational delivery cognisant of different learning needs and cultural approaches; and
- Human **empowerment** where each student is treated as unique and where the flexibility of adult learning and delivery allows participants to be self-determined about their interests and progress.

Social work field education further commits to championing the; Embedding of Indigenous ways of knowing, being and doing; Rural and remote considerations and Trauma informed practice through how we both support the student for their own journey and educate the student for their support of others in practice.

Please access the Social Work Field Education Moodle site, which will guide you in the process of applying for Field Education. This site remains available throughout the academic calendar year. The Moodle site for SOWK13009 (Fieldwork Education 1) and SOWK14009 (Field Education 2) will be made available 2 weeks before the commencement of the term and will assist with your journey by offering an interface between you and your fellow students and field education staff, to connect and ask questions, and for guiding you through the assessment requirements.

We extend our heartfelt thanks to our collaborators in providing a quality experience for all students – the organisations and agencies, individuals and teams who provide so much support and experience in supervising social work students, we appreciate everything that you do. We look forward to working with you.

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Contacts and Supports – see also the 'Support' tab in Moodle

Social work field education team

can be contacted through

Email: fieldeducation@cqu.edu.au

The Indigenous Student Engagement Team provides support to all Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander students at CQUniversity.

The Indigenous Student Engagement Team provide advice about a number of services on offer to Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander students including free tutoring support, financial guidance, cultural advocacy, safe learning support, basic course information, and more. Indigenous Student Engagement Officers are located on the Cairns, Townsville, Mackay, Rockhampton, and Bundaberg campuses.

If you are a current Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander student and would like more information about services and support provided, visit the MyCQU Student Portal. To contact the team directly, phone 07 4930 9250 or email indigenous@cqu.edu.au

Workplace health and safety

Many things can awry on placement, and it is good to know what needs to happen. In the first instance you would discuss with the field education team. Please go here to explore forms and processes as relevant and guided by your field education team.

Wellbeing/counselling services

Student Counsellors provide free and confidential support to all CQUni Students. All information about Student Counselling can be found here

The CQUni Student Counselling service is available from 8.30 am to 4.00 pm (AEST), Monday to Friday. Counsellors are currently providing telehealth services, including appointments via phone, Zoom, and email.

- Email: **counselling@cqu.edu.au**
- Phone: +61 7 4930 9456
- Visit a **study location** near you

IT Support – TaSAC

TaSAC provides CQUniversity students and staff with technical support and assistance.

Monday-Friday: 7:30am-6pm
Saturday: CLOSED
Sunday: CLOSED
Email: tasac@cqu.edu.au
Phone: 07 4930 9090 or 1300 666 620

SUPPORTING STUDENT GENDER DIVERSITY AT CQUNIVERSITY

CQUni is dedicated to creating a safe and supportive atmosphere for all students with a zero-tolerance approach to bullying and discrimination. As part of this, we have implemented an *Ally Program* to promote acceptance and understanding for lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, and intersex (LGBTI) students. The Ally program is for ALL students, whether you identify as lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, or not. There is an Ally Network on Moodle as a connection point for any student who would like to be involved, with resources, links, and forums.

It is a place for students to access support and get in contact with an Ally: https://moodle.cqu.edu.au/course/view.php?id=2599. This is also the place where students who want to become trained as Allies can do so. We join many other universities around Australia in having an Ally Program and making CQUniversity a welcoming place for all.

Academic support

The mission of the Academic Learning Centre (ALC) is to provide students with academic advice and guidance to assist them in becoming confident and independent learners.

Phone: 07 4970 7211

Email: alc-advice@cqu.edu.au

Access the ALC through MyCQU Student portal, or via the Moodle site (under Support button on taskbar)

Inclusion and Accessibility service

If you have a disability, illness, medical or mental health condition and would like support or assistance to complete your TAFE or University studies at CQUniversity, the Inclusion and Accessibility service can assist you. The Inclusion and Accessibility service aims to minimise barriers and encourage participation in education and training by all students. Reasonable adjustments including exam accommodations and provision of learning materials in alternative formats can be implemented to assist students who have registered with the Inclusion and Accessibility service.

Contact the Inclusion and Accessibility service:

Email: accessibility@cqu.edu.au

Phone: +61 7 4930 9456

Inbound Students

The International Student Support Team supports students from the point of arrival to graduation with numerous aspects of life and study in Australia

Please contact us at internationalsupport@cqu.edu.au

https://www.cqu.edu.au/international-students/inbound

Australian Social Work Education and Accreditation Standards

The Australian Social Work Education and Accreditation Standards (ASWEAS) requires that student undertake a minimum of 1,000 hours in at least two, distinctly different practice learning experiences (2021, p.10). Students will need to demonstrate that they have met these requirements in the form of timesheets, uploaded to SONIA (The Field Database).

The BSW (CC48 & CL71) has a clearly identified program structure as outlined in the student handbook, indicating SOWK13009 Field Education 1 is to be taken in Term 1 of the student's 3rd year and SOWK14009 to be taken in Term 2 of the student's 4th year.

The Australian Social Work Education and Accreditation Standards which set the requirements for social work education and accreditation in Australia (ASWEAS guidelines) state field education subjects must be taken over two years within the professional social work program of study (2021).

Key ASWEAS points include:

4.1 Field education learning experiences will enable graduates to demonstrate their ability to meet AASW practice standards across a range of diverse client groups and environments.

4.1.1 Students will complete 1,000 hours of professional practice learning involving no more than three placements.

4.1.2 At least two placements will involve distinctly different practice learning experiences.

4.1.3 At least 500 hours of placement experience must be undertaken in Australia.

4.1.4 No placement will be less than 250 hours.

4.1.5 500 hours of placement time will be undertaken in a direct practice role involving the application of professional interpersonal skills.

4.1.6 Students will complete at least one placement in a professional practice setting with an onsite social work field educator.

4.1.7 Students in employment will not have a placement in their current work role or under their current supervisor.

4.1.8 All placements will involve the active involvement of the student in social work roles.

Essential information for placement planning

1. Placements will occur in *Term 1 in the third year* for first placement, and *Term 2 in fourth year* for final placement. Both placements are across the term weeks for a period of 500 hours (approximately 14 weeks full time).
2. No placement can start earlier than two weeks prior to Term start dates (when Moodle is accessible) unless there are exceptional circumstances. This is by negotiation with the Field Education Academic Lead.
3. First placements can be part time; however, this is no less than 3 days a week. Final placement is preferred to be full time to allow for immersion into practice. If you have exceptional circumstances you can negotiate with the Field Education Academic Lead. Part time placement are contingent on approval by the host organisation.
4. Pre-placement assessment processes provide an opportunity to discuss meeting the ASWEAS and Inherent Requirements to support a successful placement experience.
5. You must prepare to attend a mandatory 5-day intensive teaching block to be able to proceed into your first field education placement *or* be approved for recognised prior learning.

Getting Ready for Field Placement 1: Checklist

		CHECK
Pre-requisites	• To be eligible to attend your first placement you will have completed all core components of your coursework for Years 1 and 2 of the BSW curriculum. • Approval to proceed without all of the year 1 & 2 components is only negotiable through the approval of the Head of Course for the Social Work Program. • *Co-requisite*: SOWK13010 Integrating theory and practice 1. • You must ensure that your study plan is up to date to guarantee you do not miss out on receiving an invitation to apply.	
Moodle Sites	• Log in to the Social Work Field Education Moodle site – here you will find details of mandatory requirements, please follow this carefully. • Please ensure you explore this site and get familiar with it.	
Mandatory Checks	• Start arranging your vaccinations – as these can take up to 8 months to complete – if you do not complete the mandatory requirements	

		CHECK
	you will not be eligible to go on placement Click here for Mandatory requirements. • Electronically submit all applications, mandatory documentation, and declarations on time through SONIA. • Please refer to the Mandatory Checks tile on the Social Work Field Education Moodle site.	
Application to attend field placement	• *Applying for field placement*: note this is different to the usual *'enrol'* in a unit, field education staff have to ensure students are 'placement ready' so there may be additional requirements. • The Field Placement Application is designed to assist the field staff in matching students with appropriate field sites and requests specific information on the student's employment/volunteer experience, previous field placement experiences, learning experiences requested and special needs or requests, it takes a while to complete but the more information you supply the better the match with your host organisation. • Applications are submitted through SONIA - The Work Integrated Learning (WIL) Database – which will generate an email notifying you of the field education application commencement. • You will be alerted through email about your access to SONIA and a due date to complete your Field Education Application within the database.	
SONIA	• Ensure you watch the SONIA video on the SWFE Moodle site.	
Where to go in field placement?	• You will indicate in your application form your areas of interest - think about where your interests lie – you may not get your first preference for a placement as there are many other Universities placing students at the same time, so be prepared to diversify from your original interest areas. • Reflect and prepare through careful consideration of fields of practice linked with social work skills and methods. Ask questions, and research online what is available for social workers – there are many fields of practice.	

		CHECK
Resume – Update now	• Consult with support staff of the university in order to collate a resume which will be useful and readable, CQUni's CareerHub has a resume builder and offers great advice for how to write a good resume - https://careerhub.cqu.edu.au/ • The resume forms part of your application, and is sent to potential host organisations, ensure it looks professional, even if you do not have much experience to list.	
Preplacement planning	• Reflect and prepare for potential placement interviews with human services organisations with an emphasis on the articulation of an emerging framework for social practice. Treat the preplacement planning meeting as an interview to prepare for your placement interview as if you are going for a job! • The field education team will arrange this planning meeting to discuss your preferences, then will match you with the best suitable organisation available– then interviews will be offered by these organisations. • Students *can* indicate a preference or name an organisation but ***should not*** approach the organisation themselves, the Field Education team has that responsibility and maintains links with many prospective organisations.	
Student Declaration	• Declarations made through SONIA include consent for the field education team to share sensitive information with human service organisations on a *need-to-know basis*; disclosure of circumstances that may adversely affect the student or organisation; confidentiality agreements about learning undertaken; and potential conflicts of interest.	
Reviewing your Field Education application	• The Field Education team may provide you with feedback in regard to the learning that still needs to be undertaken or resources and supports required.	

		CHECK
	• You must indicate your acceptance of any feedback provided to you and acknowledgement of responsibility for either progressing to placement or reviewing placement timing.	
All the time	• It is vitally important to consistently monitor your CQUni email address, and also familiarise yourself with the Social Work Fieldwork Education Moodle site – you need to stay connected! N.B. CQUni will not communicate through non-CQU email addresses.	
Recognised Prior Learning	• RPL applications are due ***concurrently*** with your field education 1 applications and you MUST communicate with the UC regarding your submission at all times (Please refer to the nominated tile in the SWFE Moodle Site for steps).	
Work Based Placements	• Work Based Placement are considered through the application process (as per SWFE Moodle site) and are due approximately **one month after** you meet with a member of the FE Team for your pre placement planning assessment meeting. • WBP will only be considered following the submission of the WBP application form and then a meeting **must** be arranged by yourself with the UC and your line manager or appointed staff member from the planned organisation for your WBP. • We can then proceed for approval with the field education panel • Following the approval the WBP *agreement* must be signed and submitted.	

SONIA – Your Work Integrated Learning Platform

SONIA beginning instructions:

1. Once you ***enrol*** in Bachelor of Social Work, you will receive an email from SONIA with a link and your login details – keep it handy!
    - Then follow the link that will bring you to a *landing page* click the Forms tab at the top of the landing page.
2. As long as you have ***'planned' your field education units*** in the correct term and ensured you are eligible you will receive an invitation to apply to field education 1 or 2.
    - There will be a form waiting for you entitled **Field Education Application Form** – this should be completed fully.
    - Please *allow plenty of time for this process*, as it is a vital document that is used by the field education team to establish where you are on your social work journey in terms of learning and experience.
    - *This form is used to match you to potential host organisations* and will be shared with prospective agencies, so you must ***ensure you have presented yourself as professionally as possible.***
    - There is a link within the form to *attach your current resume*. Please ensure this looks clear and professional. There is assistance available for the CQUni careers hub in writing a good resume – and it should be no more than 2 pages long.
    - *Sign and submit the form* – it then goes to the field education team for the application process to start.
3. The 2nd step is to add the **Student Declaration Form**, by once again clicking the Forms tab and selecting it from the drop-down menu.
4. Once you have completed the *application form* and the *student declaration form* then click the 'Checks' tab at the top of the page. This will show all the mandatory checks which are required to allow you to go on placement, and this is where you upload the evidence that the checks have been completed.
5. Once you have attended your field placement interview and your placement is confirmed please go into SONIA and self-select the **Interview Notification and Placement Confirmation Form** as soon as possible to ensure we are clear on your plan.

Your Field Education Team

***Field Education Academic Lead** (AL) and **Unit Coordinator** (UC) – An appointed academic member of the CQU staff, possessing a minimum of 5 years post-qualifying social work experience. The UC is responsible for the overall management of the field education program, unit coordination for SOWK13009 and SWOK14009, as well as supporting placement finding, final grading within the units and any placement concerns as they arise.

**Referred to throughout the rest of this document as Unit Coordinator (UC).*

Field Education Coordinator (FEC) – An appointed academic member of the CQU staff, possessing a minimum of 5 years post-qualifying social work experience. The Field Education Coordinator works with you to arrange your preferred placement options, liaises with workplaces, and fulfils all the duties of ensuring your placement runs smoothly and supports the management of the field education program and the teaching and marking for SOWK13009 and SOWK14009.

Field Education Liaison Coordinator (FELC) - An appointed academic member of the CQU staff, possessing a minimum of 5 years post-qualifying social work experience. The FELC will provide a link between the student and CQUni, by maintaining links with student and field educators, supporting the writing of the learning plans, attending (in person or virtually) a mid-placement review, and supporting student progress. The FELC role also works closely with industry and advises on best practices for the liaison role.

Field Education Liaison Officers (FELO) – are appointed academic members of the CQU staff, in a casual position. They will possess a minimum of 5 years of post-qualifying social work experience. At times other staff from the social work teaching team will take on this role. Field Education liaisons provide a link between the student and CQUni, through maintaining links with student and field educators, supporting the writing of the learning plans, attending (in person or virtually) a mid-placement review, and supporting student progress.

***Field Educator** – this person is a *social worker* who would be your direct contact in your placement organisation. The role is educative, administrative, and supportive – and is performed by a social worker with at least 2 years post-graduate practice in the field. The Field Educator will provide supervision or 1 – 1.5 hours per 5 days of attendance and is your go-to person for any questions. Depending on the agency this field educator may be responsible for directing you in your daily practice, or this role may be delegated, but the Field Educator offers learning support to achieve your learning goals, and practical support in establishing your role and activities in the agency.

***Onsite/Task supervisor** – This person is someone who is onsite with the organsiation however, is not a social worker. They will introduce you to the organisation, oversee your day-to-day practice, offer feedback and task supervision, and support your learning agreement goals in conjunction with the external supervisor.

**Please note that when referring to Field Educator throughout the manual this could mean either or both of the above roles.*

External Field Educator/Supervisor - In cases where a social worker is not available on site for this role, CQUni will appoint a social worker external to the agency, to provide the 1 - 1.5 hours of formal social work supervision required.

Workplace Integrated Learning Team (WIL) – ensure compliance with mandatory requirements, such as vaccinations. The WIL team handle all workplace learning for CQU and are not solely concerned with the School of Social Work. The WIL team can answer any enquiries regarding mandatory requirements.

Roles and responsibilities

Responsibilities	Field Educator	Onsite Task Supervisor	External Supervisor
Familiarity and adherence to AASW policy on education standards for Field Education	✓	✓	✓
Facilitate opportunities for students to achieve the University's academic standards through assessment items for SOWK13009 and SOWK14009	✓	✓	✓
Provide a quality learning environment including reasonable access to necessary equipment.	✓	✓	
Provide at least 1.5 hours of formal structured supervision per 35 hours of placement.	✓		✓
Liaise and negotiate with external supervisors and provide supervision on operational matters.		✓	
Raise concerns about performance against learning agreement with students on time.	✓	✓	✓
Raise concerns about student conflict on time.	✓	✓	✓

Seek early intervention consultations with Field Education Team as necessary.	✓	✓	✓
Attend and participate in the Learning Agreement meeting and the Mid Placement review.	✓	✓	✓
Provide written evaluation of student performance at end of placement in a timely manner.	✓		✓

Engaging in the fieldwork placement

Attendance

Days and times of attendance are negotiated with the field educator/task supervisor in the host organisation. This should be clarified at the beginning of the placement, and it is the responsibility of the student to enter all timesheets into SONIA. This is an important requirement as it constitutes proof that you have fulfilled the requirements of the hours in the unit.

Placement hours are usually expected to be full-time with some flexibility on a case-by-case basis. Total hours do not include travel to and from your placement, lunch or other breaks, and public holidays. If there is a public holiday during your placement you will be expected to make up the hours.

If you fall sick on placement, again the hours have to be made up – a medical certificate is required for absences of two or more consecutive days. Notification of absences must be supplied to the field educator/ onsite supervisor, as well as the UC by email.

If a student falls ill and requires an extension to the placement, this must be discussed with the UC, who will then liaise with the other parties in the host organisation and the University to ensure a satisfactory outcome. A medical certificate is required if requesting an extension for health reasons.

Students are also able to request an extension on compassionate grounds (such as sorry business), where a significant event impacts their ability to continue, this must be discussed with the UC which will ensure all parties in the host organisation and the university are aware.

Hours on Placement

Students are required to complete a field education log of hours through SONIA. It is expected that all students will complete this daily requiring their field educator/onsite supervisor to approve weekly if possible. In addition, this form is also used to document supervision sessions. The UC may view timesheets at any time. Students and field educators need to be mindful that the timesheet is a

legal document and informs students of indemnity and insurance coverage for accidents while engaging in field education.

The log of hours must be an accurate and complete reflection **of hours worked and supervision provided.** If any amendments to hours worked or weeks undertaken during field education change in significant ways other than time in lieu, as noted below, the UC needs to approve this proposal. On approval, the learning agreement needs to be amended to reflect any changes.

Guidelines On Working Hours

Students are required to be punctual and dedicated to the hours of work negotiated with their field educator. If students are going to be late, it is expected that they will contact their field educator as per usual professional courtesies. Any hours missed will be made up in negotiation with your field educator. Alternatively, if extra hours are worked at the request of your field educator, arrangements for time in lieu within the fortnight can be made without contacting the UC. It is not acceptable to accumulate more than 8 hours total in lieu at any time. Your working hours are aligned with the usual working hours of the agency you are placed within.

Lunch Hours

Students cannot count lunchtime hours as part of their total placement hours; regardless of any placement organisation's policy.

Intensive Learning Block Hours

The ASWEAS states that the HEP program of practice–theory integration activities may be included within the required hours of the placement up to a maximum of 7 hours per 250 hours of placement, with a maximum of 28 hours across all field education placements. Therefore, you can count 14 hours from the intensive learning block toward placement theory integration.

What If your placement is impacted by COVID-19?

There is no allowance approved through the AASW for time off due to contracting COVID-19 and becoming unwell to be added to hours. In this instance, the same rules will apply as if you became unwell with any sickness that meant you could not return to work. In this case, you will make up the hours within your placement to meet the required hours.

There may be some allowance in hours granted if you are impacted by Covid closures that are beyond your control, whereby your agency does not give you work-from-home responsibilities. This will be on a case-by-case basis, and you will need to discuss this with the Field Education team and require approval from the UC.

Student Withdrawal from Placement

If the student withdraws from placement after the census date, then the student's particular case will be assessed individually by the Field Education team, in conjunction with appropriate University staff. In some instances, students become unwell or there are unforeseen external circumstances that may pose a significant barrier to completion of the placement. In such circumstances, if a medical certificate / appropriate supporting documentation is supplied and there were no issues around achieving learning outcomes required of a student in the placement before this, then a decision can be made to recommend intermission of placement. However, if the student withdraws from placement due to difficulties/learning issues in the placement and or the student and/or academic staff are aware the student's placement is likely to be terminated due to fitness to practice issues etc, then this will be assessed by the UC, and a fail can be awarded. Should a student withdraw from placement without prior consultation with the field education team, a fail grade may be issued.

Professional Conduct

Students undertaking Field Education must abide by the CQU Student Charter and also consider the *Inherent Requirements of the social work degree.*

Students must adhere to confidentiality and privacy requirements at all times. Any breach may result in a termination of placement and a Fail grade.

While engaged in field education students are ambassadors of the profession, the University, the program they are studying and themselves. It is important to consider the first impression you make with the organisation and the impression with which you leave them. This includes your non-verbal communication, your interactions with colleagues and clients and the way you present yourself.

Inherent Requirements

The Bachelor of Social Work (CL71) at CQU incorporates key principles outlined in the AASW Code of Ethics (2020), ASWEAS (2021), and the Profession Specific Graduate Attributes. Students pursuing this degree must meet the inherent requirements necessary to ensure they can effectively contribute to the social work profession.

Students with disabilities or other special circumstances may be provided with *reasonable adjustments* to enable them to meet the inherent academic requirements of the Bachelor of Social Work, provided the adjustment is:

1. *Logistically reasonable*: The adjustment should not impose an unjustifiable hardship on the educational institution, nor compromise the academic integrity of the course.

2. *Likely to result in the student being able to perform the skills adequately and in a timely manner*: The adjustment should enable the student to achieve the required level of competence while preserving the learning outcomes and professional standards of the course.

It is essential to maintain the professional standards and requirements set by the AASW Code of Ethics (2020) and ASWEAS (2021) while providing adjustments to students. This ensures that students develop the necessary skills and knowledge to succeed in their social work career and contribute effectively to the welfare of individuals and communities.

CQU is committed to providing support and assistance to students with disabilities or special circumstances, ensuring that they have equal opportunities to achieve success in their academic pursuits while preserving the integrity and standards of the Bachelor of Social Work course.

1. **Ethical Behaviour**: Students *must* demonstrate knowledge of, and engage in ethical behaviour in practice, adhering to the AASW Code of Ethics (2020) and ASWEAS (2021).
2. **Communication**: Students *must* be able to communicate effectively and respectfully with diverse populations, understand and respond to verbal and non-verbal cues, and accurately record and comprehend information.
3. **Reflective Skills**: Students *must* be able to accurately reflect on their professional performance, accept feedback, and manage personal issues that may impact their progress in the course.
4. **Observation and Sensory Skills**: Students *must* be able to observe and monitor their environment, interpret client appearance, posture, movement, and speech, and conduct group work.
5. **Physical Capacity and Sustainability**: Students *must* be able to attend field education placements in various settings and geographical locations (within reasonable proximity to their place of residence) and meet ongoing immunisation requirements.
6. **Intellectual & Cognitive Abilities**: Students *must* be able to gather, comprehend, and organise information, integrate theory and knowledge, develop and assess options, engage in rational and ethical reasoning, and complete tasks in a safe and reasonable timeframe.
7. **Behavioural Stability**: Students *must* be able to behave consistently and in a stable manner, work effectively in uncertain environments, accept responsibilities, respond to constructive feedback, participate in group discussions, manage their physical and mental health, respect personal and professional boundaries, and manage interpersonal conflict.

Dress Code

In most organisations, the dress code would be termed as “smart casual”. Pay attention to how your field educators and co-workers dress. Dress may also differ according to the appointments you have scheduled such as the difference in dress required for a court observation compared to a home visit. If in doubt, ask the people around you, you are there to learn.

When observing dress code also consider workplace health and safety issues, for example, enclosed shoes may be non-negotiable in some work contexts. You may need to be mindful of planned or unplanned contact with people from cultures where modesty is important.

Keep in mind how your style of clothing can communicate and increase the power differences between you, clients, and colleagues. It is allowable for social work students to wear CQUniversity student shirts available at the bookshop if you wish, but it is not necessary to identify as a ‘social work’ student. Wearing a uniform of any kind within the social work degree is not required by the University. The wearing of a CQUniversity shirt must be approved by the field educator before purchase to ensure any agency preferences are respected.

Social Media

CQU has a detailed policy on the use of Social Media and this should be read in conjunction with the Student Behavioural Misconduct Procedure.

Fitness for Practice

Evaluating Placement Readiness Before Field Education 1

In addition to the field education workshops delivered on campus, to prepare students for this part of the curriculum, every student is evaluated for their capacity to complete their field education experience successfully before the initiation of negotiations with human service organisations. A range of administrative, human resource and reflective practices are undertaken before an organisation is approached to host a student on placement.

Before the field education team contacts organisations students must have:

Completed any pre-requisite coursework in Years 1 and 2 of their BSW curriculum;

- Indicated their field education interests approximately six months prior while advised that unexpected learning outcomes can occur in human services contexts they may not have considered;

- Consulted with support staff of the university to collate a resume that observes contemporary trends in human resources;
- Reflected and prepared through careful consideration of fields of practice linked with social work skills and methods;
- Applications should be inclusive of consideration to placement readiness and inherent requirements;
- Reflect and prepare for potential pre-placement interviews with human services organisations with an emphasis on the articulation of an emerging framework for social practice; and
- Electronically submit through SONIA all documentation and declarations *in a timely manner demonstrating competent management of administrative systems*.
- Documentation includes (as per agency requirement)
    - Mandatory requirements such as Working with Children Check;
    - Criminal history check;
    - Vaccine-preventable; and
    - Confirmation of current driver's license.

    Please Note – if you are intending to go into Health then ALL mandatory checks are required.
- Student Declaration includes
    - consent for field education coordinators to share sensitive information with human service organisations on a need-to-know basis;
    - disclosure of circumstances that may adversely affect the student or organisation;
    - confidentiality agreements about learning undertaken; and
    - potential conflicts of interest;

The Field Education Team may provide you with feedback regarding the learning that still needs to be undertaken or the resources and supports required. You must indicate your acceptance of any feedback provided to you and acknowledge responsibility for either progressing to placement or reviewing placement timing.

Fitness to practice may be influenced by changes to a student's personal psychological, emotional, physical, and spiritual wellbeing. Fitness to practise may also be influenced by organisational contexts thwarting a student's progress. Personal, interpersonal, and organisational stressors can combine to affect a student's capacity to continue with a field education experience despite being assessed as placement-ready or satisfying the first formal review conducted by the field liaison.

At any other stage during field education, fitness for practice can be affected resulting in a range of problematic consequences for students, field educators, clients, and placement organisations such as:

- A breach of the AASW Code of Ethics and/or organisational Code of Conduct; Inability to perform practice standards to a minimum that has been articulated prior; Non-approved departures from the learning agreement;
- Failure to maintain confidentiality in everyday practice or academic submissions;
- Failure to display duty of care for clients and/or agency workers;
- Inappropriate interpersonal behaviour;
- Unethical decision-making and behaviour;
- Contravention of agency policies;
- The bullying or harassment of University lecturers, field educators, co-workers or clients;
- Contravention of workplace directions provided by field educators, operational supervisors, external field educators, Field Education Team, or other personnel to whom students are accountable as per the learning agreement;
- Unexplained absences or failing to report for duty.

Any of the above behaviours may occur despite an absence of prior conflict with clients or personnel in the organisation. In some of the above cases instigating the conflict resolution process will be deemed appropriate by the UC. In other instances, an immediate decision about the progress of placement must be made.

Unless a field educator determines that they place themselves at risk in the presence of a student it is preferred that the student be informed of the actions decided upon before their implementation.

When a field educator and/or an external field educator deem a student to be unfit for practice they must contact the UC and provide written feedback based on the criteria that follow.

Fitness For Practice Criteria

A measure of whether fitness for practice is at the heart of concern can be evaluated by reflecting on whether the placement would have been offered to the student had information about the values, decision-making processes or behaviours affecting their fitness to practise been known to the organisation before approving the placement.

Overall, fitness for practice *cannot be self-assessed by a student* unless there is self-efficacy which is ‘the beliefs people have about their capabilities to produce certain levels of

performance that have an impact on events that affect their lives' (Parker 2006, p.1022). Self-knowledge, self-esteem, and self-concept refer to a student's ability to be reflective, value self and hold certain cognitions about their student role respectively. However, a student may possess all of these qualities without a belief or confidence that they can undertake the tasks agreed at any given time due to a range of the abovementioned stressors. In some instances, students may assess that their self-efficacy is waning, however, at other times due to the issue of associated confidence it will be necessary to any of the other abovementioned stakeholders to raise concerns about a student's ongoing practice.

The following criteria are a guide to provide students and field educators with a framework for communicating and replanning learning agendas when fitness to practise is in question. The model provided by Charles, Clarke, and Evans (2006) is derived from ten months of action research and the inclusion of clients, consumer groups, academic staff, students, and tutors in field education.

Fitness for Practice. Behaviours that demonstrate:	**Concerns about fitness for practice for discussion Behaviours that demonstrate:**
Sensitive work with service users	Insensitive work with service users such as disrespectful verbal and non-verbal communication, inappropriate humour, non-observance of cultural differences in interaction
Anti-oppressive work with service users	Lack of insight into intrusive practice with service users such as over-assessment, plans for prescriptive interventions, or collusion with systems abuse.
Unconditional positive regard for diverse service users and communities	Interactions with service users and communities are fulfilling the unmet personal needs of the student
Creative communications in diverse ways	Reliance on one mode of communication, and unwillingness or inability to consider service user diversity when receiving and providing information
Adherence to confidentiality, privacy, and information-sharing legislation and policies.	Placing confidential service user and community information at risk of civil action such as providing referrals beyond a 'need to know' basis, taking files home, neglecting to obscure personal details when they are not required in decision making, engaging in 'corridor talk'
Assessment of risk, and balancing this with opportunity	Lack of awareness of service users or community risks such as agreeing to meet service users in unsafe locations, non-reporting of observed harmful behaviours, and colluding with workplace harassment and bullying.

Identify service user needs, aspirations, requirements, and entitlements.	Insufficient assessment plans, failure to communicate the student role, neglect of research of resources available, non-inclusion of service users and communities in the planning process, and neglect to inform service users of rights to query service quality.
Time management and the ability to prioritise appropriately.	Inability to prioritise appropriately leading to incidents or risks, while less important tasks have been addressed, continued inability to meet deadlines such as start times, meetings, written submissions
Working as a team member and service employee	Non-observance of team input into decision making, such as non-consultation on student tasks and daily priorities, verbal and non-verbal communication demonstrating resistance to engage with other team members, and inability to articulate insights into team and organisational dynamics.

Information Sharing About Fitness To Practise

1. The university and the field education team have a responsibility to ensure that all measures have been taken to reduce the risk of harm to students, clients, and placement organisational staff. The field education team's role is unique in social work education, and it is not usual to receive information from multiple stakeholders that is sensitive.
    a. ***Confidentiality*** and privacy requirements are taken very seriously by CQUniversity social work team and staff. ***However***, there are times when information needs to be shared about students' unique needs gathered from the process of placement readiness or concerns about fitness to practise.
    b. ***The process of assessing*** fitness to practise may include obtaining information from various university records, previous lecturers and observations of students attending residential education. Information may be requested of staff on a 'need to know' basis and is released on a 'need to know' basis.
    c. ***Safeguards*** put in place for students include discussion of student concerns at social work staff meetings where the identity of the student is not shared, seeking the permission of students to share identifying information among the social work team and encouraging students to take responsibility for communicating their needs directly.
2. If the student is initiating a consultation about their insights into fitness to practise they are encouraged to share this information with their field educator especially if their concerns are immediate and serious.
    a. If fitness to practise is being affected by safety in the learning experience, a student is not subject to providing or demonstrating evidence.

b. It is sufficient for the student and/or the field educator to communicate to the field education team that (for whatever reason) the safety of the student is no longer guaranteed and the placement needs to be evaluated immediately.
c. If this is not possible, students should contact the field education team for support and open, honest discussion about the most appropriate plan of action.
d. If this openness of communication cannot be agreed upon in discussions among any combination of students, field educators or field education team, the latter role will deploy communications that safeguard all stakeholders as they see fit.
e. Unless the field education team has concerns about the safety of any stakeholder on disclosing information without a student's consent, they will ensure that the student is informed about this decision before acting.

CONCERN'S PROCESSES

Solution-Focussed Conflict Resolution

The framework for addressing concerns around values and behaviours during a student's field education experience is informed by solution-focused and strength-based perspectives.

In the ***first instance,*** field educators are asked to raise concerns with students directly to negotiate necessary changes. We encourage both students and field educators to take a proactive approach to early intervention with concerns that arise using the feedback loops of supervision to deal with issues constructively.

If issues cannot be resolved, the following processes are recommended as a starting point in line with the AASW's Code of Ethics, principles of natural justice (especially the right of reply) and human dignity. The process below is also informed by CQUniversity policies such as the Student Misconduct Policy, Student Behavioural Misconduct Procedure, and the Student Charter.

It is in everyone's best interest to resolve conflict quickly when it arises between a student and field educator or students and other members of an organisation's staff. The following considerations are offered as a starting point only:

1. Students must *embed within their learning agreements* as a preventive measure, about conflict resolution with either field educators or other members of staff, (See Assessment 1 learning Agreement in Course Profile);

2. Students must *familiarise themselves with organisational processes* for conflict resolution and if the process presented in this section conflicts with that of the organisation's policies and

procedures, consult with the field education team before the learning agreement is assessed to be passed.

3. Students must consider the “Human Relations” department/team within an organisation is considered in a student placement to be the UC, and ***should not*** pursue formal complaints against an agency staff member/field educator via the Organisational Human Relations avenues *without* first consulting with the FE team and/or university staff member;

4. Reflect on the issue of concern and discern *what contributions all parties have made* toward the conflict to be able to be fully addressed;

5. Any person involved in the issue of concern is asked to reflect and discern what elements of the overall goal/experience/task/relationship/practice were accomplished and which were not;

6. The person with the concern evaluates the appropriate space, time of day and time of week to raise the concern confining this discussion to the person/people affected by the conflict. Mapping who is ‘in’ and who is ‘out’ of this initial interpersonal communication is essential;

7. If the person with the concern assesses that they cannot raise the issue directly with others associated with the conflict, for example, if it relates to issues such as harassment or bullying, students must proceed to step #9 in the process. If field educators are subject to harassment or bullying, they are required to report their concerns to the appropriate roles in their organisation and contact the field education team immediately;

8. If initial concerns about serious matters are resolved the field education team may share information with the mid-placement liaison visitor who will readdress these issues;

9. If the facilitation of conflict resolution is not satisfactory to either party, students or field educators must advise the field education team and the involvement of the university will be negotiated on time on a case-by-case basis;

10. Any student who has concerns about sexual harassment should approach their field educator immediately. If this is not possible, they should contact the field education team *immediately* who will treat each response on a case-by-case basis;

11. If a student demonstrates unsatisfactory behaviour in any of their assessments in field education including an aggressive manner to the field education team they will be reported for disciplinary processes.

EVALUATION OF FITNESS TO PRACTICE ON PLACEMENT

Formal evaluation of student competency	
If the Field Educator has concerns about student's fitness to practice:	If there are any concerns about a student's fitness to practice, all parties are encouraged to address these concerns as early as possible.
Mid Placement Review:	Concerns about a student's performance need to be raised during the Mid-Placement Review (MPR) meeting at the ***latest***. The discussion at the MPR with the Field Liaison allows for a plan of action that will maximise students' chances of responding and accomplishing the learning needs and goals originally identified. The MPR is recorded in the learning agreement form by the student made available to the Field Liaison and submitted to the UC for approval. If an action plan is required, this will be included in this form and submitted following the workflow as above before your *Mid Placement Assessment* with the field education team.
The next formal evaluation of the field education experience occurs at the end of the field education report.	At any point between these two formal evaluations, any person may raise concerns about a student's fitness to practice. This can include, • student, • field educator, • external field educator, • field education team, • social work academic team, • management or staff in your host organisation, • program director or • client of an agency
When concerns have been raised about a student's fitness to practice:	The evaluation process is to be appropriately documented and meetings between the participants minuted for the University's records. The evaluation will assess the following information to be shared among all parties identified below:

	1. Evidence of the factors that led to the determination that a student's behaviours deemed them unfit for ongoing student practice; 2. Direct links between the concerns raised and contravention of the learning agreement; 3. Student feedback on their field education experience with direct links to the behaviours concerned; 4. Feedback from any other relevant sources in the organisation; 5. Feedback from the external field educator if applicable; 6. Other feedback sought by the University as necessary; 7. Student's right to reply to information provided; 8. Field educator and organisation's right of reply and recommendation; 9. University's right of reply and recommendation.
Outcomes:	As a result of the placement review process, there are four possible outcomes: • No change required; • Revision of learning agreement; • Intermission of field education placement; • Termination of field education placement.
No Change required:	If, as a result of active participation in the above process or the above-mentioned conflict resolution process, a determination about fitness to practice has been made on misinformation, lack of communication or misunderstanding, the field education experience can continue with no changes noted.
Revision of Learning Agreement:	If, as a result of active participation in the above process or the abovementioned conflict resolution process, concerns are explained, and evaluated and strategies for change are implemented to each stakeholder's satisfaction; the placement will proceed with new arrangements noted in the learning agreement.
Intermission of Field Placement:	If a student agrees to the recommendation for suspending time in field education, being cognisant of their rights within the process

	outlined in this section above, and this coincides with an organisation's capacity to initiate the remainder of the placement at a later date, this consensual agreement will be noted and implemented.
Termination of Field Education:	If a student acknowledges and complies with the recommendation that a field education experience be terminated immediately, being cognisant of their rights within the process outlined in this section above, this consensual agreement will be noted and implemented. The host organisation retains the right to withdraw a placement if their concerns are not adequately addressed.
No satisfactory resolution: The panel convened will consist of two faculty staff members including the Field Education Academic lead, the field educator(s) and/or a representative of the organisation, an independent industry representative (such as an experienced social work field educator) and staff employed by Student Services to assess equity.	If there is no satisfactory resolution to concerns about fitness for practice, an assessment will be made by the field education team and a decision recommended accordingly. A panel may be convened to determine the outcome of complex placement decisions. The panel will listen, assess, and determine whether there is sufficient evidence that the student has performed unsatisfactorily and /or inappropriately in their field education placement, and/or whether the organisational context poses a threat to the ongoing progress of the learning agreement. The panel will then meet with the student (either in person or through the use of a teleconferencing facility) to discuss the assessment arrived through the evaluation of her/his placement performance.
The outcome of panel discussion:	If the panel recommends that an intermission in the original timelines proposed should occur; the suspension takes effect immediately. The UC will communicate this outcome to the student as soon as practicable. This communication can be by telephone in the first instance, email or letter. Every attempt will be made to contact the student by phone but if unsuccessful, other methods will be used in lieu.

When an Incident Occurs

Placements can present many challenges, not only learning curves or conflicts, but sometimes an incident of emotional, physical, or even sexual harm can happen.

In the first instance, you would approach your supervisor at the workplace, then include your Field Liaison staff member who will then include the UC.

Please complete the appropriate incident reporting processes or ask for assistance to address this as soon after the incident as possible. You will find the information sheet on Critical Incidents here.

There is a university-wide approach to managing these so please go to the *Work Integrated Learning (Wil) Student Incident Reporting, Investigation And Insurance Coverage Guideline.*

Please do not hesitate to ask for assistance at any time from the field education team

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Assessment Requirements for Placements

The student is required to complete the following:

- 1000 Hours of field education over your third- and fourth-year level of study
- Regular reflective supervision with a qualified social worker
- Satisfactory demonstration of performance within the placement organisation
- Completion of all assessment requirements as per *Unit Outline*
- Complete all tasks associated with SONIA the work-integrated learning platform.
    - Health and Safety Orientation form (due in week 1)
    - Log of hours completed daily/weekly and signed off by onsite supervisor.

Summary Of Assessment Requirements

Refer to the ***Course outline for full details***.

All items are Pass/Fail with a *requirement* to Pass all items to pass the course:

Assessment 1: *The Learning Journey*

This assessment task seeks to encapsulate your learning by developing achievable goals related to your placement experience. This task is in three parts; each part is on the same form and is to be submitted at three points across the placement.

1) **The Learning Agreement** (*Creating Goals*)

    a) Written by you in consultation with your supervisor, and Field Liasion,

b) Once approved this is then submitted to Moodle.

2) **The Mid Placement Review & Assessment** (*Evidencing Goals*)
   a) Notes taken by you during this meeting outlining strengths, evidence that goals are being met and what needs developing. You will then complete the MPR section of your LA form.
   b) For your ***first placement*** you will then attend a Mid Placement Assessment (MPA) meeting with one of the field education teams for final approval that you are on track in your learning.
3) **The End of Placement Report** (*Achieved Goals*)
   a) In your final supervision meeting, you and your supervisor will review your learning journey by engaging in a reflective discussion.
   b) You may choose to include your Field Liaison in this final meeting (but not required).
   c) You will then complete the EPR section of your LA form, reflecting on each standard you wrote to in your learning goals, and then email this to your supervisor for their assessment.
   d) They will then return this to you to submit to Moodle.

Assessment 2: *The Reflective Journey*

- This assessment task is to guide you in developing your reflective capacity; critically, sensitively, and reflexively.
- Students in SOWK13009 are encouraged to keep a daily personal professional journal for enhancing and exploring the critically reflective practice and provide a summary of their learning in critically reflective practice at the end of the term.
- SOWK14009 students are expected to share learnings in critically reflective practice and reflexive thinking through a regular online forum and provide a summary of this experience.

You are asked to use the following tools to assist you in your reflective journey through your placements:

1. **Supervision records and action plan** (*Personal* and *Professional Reflections*)
   a. Completed weekly following your supervision sessions and shared with your supervisor/s.
2. **Online Moodle forums** (*Peer Reflections*)
   a. You will share with your student colleagues your placement experiences at least three points throughout placement and share strength-based feedback on each other's journeys.

Assessment 3: *Social Work Practice Framework (PF)*

This assessment task seeks to develop your understanding of yourself as a developing social worker and to consider this within the context of the agency you are undertaking placement. You will also share a short reflection on your placement journey at this time. This assessment is designed to offer opportunities for feedback, and you are also encouraged to discuss your assessments with your supervisor.

This task has two parts

1. **The PF** – You will develop a short presentation that you share with your peers in small groups.
2. You will then have the opportunity to amend this after feedback and *submit this to Moodle one week after your presentation*.

N.B., For the first placement (SOWK13009) your SWPF will take place online and for your final placement (SOWK14009) you will be expected to enhance your PF from the first placement which will be developed and submitted as a video summary of your developed social work identity to date. ***Please ensure you are guided by the Assessment outlines in Moodle.***

Framework for Assessment

Assessment for both first and final placement is based on the AASW Code of Ethics (2020), Australian Social Work Education and Accreditation Standards (ASWEAS 2021) and the AASW Standards for Social Work Practice (2023):

1. Social workers conduct themselves according to the values, principles and guidelines of the AASW Code of Ethics 2020.
2. Social workers practice in partnership with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples to support their priorities and aspirations.
3. Social workers advocate for policy initiatives and approaches to practice aimed at achieving fair and equitable access for people to social, health, economic, environmental and political resources.
4. Social workers practice respectfully and inclusively concerning culture and diversity.
5. Social workers practice within a professional knowledge framework informed by a critical understanding of contemporary social work theory and research.
6. Social workers make professional decisions based on a holistic assessment of the needs, strengths, goals and preferences of people.

7. Social workers actively contribute to strengthening and promoting the identity and standing of the profession.
8. Social workers build and strengthen their practice through regular structured supervision from social work qualified supervisors.
9. Social workers monitor their skills, knowledge, and expertise to maintain, improve and broaden their professional development.

All stakeholders must be committed to adhering to and accomplishing the aspirations of the AASW. The positions adopted by the AASW on the professional education of social workers must override any conflicting individual, organisational or academic agendas for the duration of both field education programs. The expectations of the AASW are paramount when engaging in complex decision-making about standards of practice, student progress or the general direction of a field education experience.

The CQU Social Work Field Education Unit framework provides the academic team conducting field education activities with the overall framework to determine placement readiness, address fitness for practice issues related to field education experiences and support the development of relevant knowledge of the student. This in turn, supports academic staff to make equitable and professional judgements about the student's ability to utilise social work skills, knowledge, and judgement whilst in placement, and/or their ability to build the skills and knowledge in practice.

The framework provides and meets the requirements of due diligence, ensuring the safety and wellbeing of students and clients/organisations with which students will work while on placement.

In **Field Education 1**, the emphasis is on supporting students to demonstrate that they can **evaluate** and justify the most fitting social work theory, method, process of change and strategies for feedback from a range of options. Evaluation is one part of the process of reflective practice while generating knowledge of a range of options demonstrates the capacity for reflexive practice.

During **Field Education 2**, the emphasis is on the demonstration of evaluation skills leading to a student's capacity to **create** or scaffold new syntheses or relationships between the various elements of social work knowledge, values, and skills.

The emphasis in the final field education experience is the student's ability to evaluate the best knowledge, values and skills brought to a social work scenario and the capacity to generate a new idea from this convergence.

Demonstration of this higher-order analysis occurs through the final submissions of personal practice frameworks embedded in professional portfolios or final assessments. Similarly, the

evaluation and marking of assessment items associated with field education and co-requisite courses also reinforce these distinctions by using the language of ‘evaluation’ and ‘creation’.

Learning outcomes for First Placement SOWK13009:

On successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

1. Develop and demonstrate the integration of professional social work knowledge, skills, and values within the placement context, in alignment with the AASW Code of Ethics and AASW Practice Standards, and organisational context for practice, including adherence to legislative and policy frameworks.
2. Reflect on your professional practice, incorporating self-care strategies, and use of self in the organisational context along with problem-solving skills, and cross-cultural competency.
3. Create opportunities to develop your skills in the assessment of clients' needs and evaluating appropriate intervention strategies using social work theoretical frameworks.
4. Construct a professional practice framework relevant to your emerging social work practice and demonstrate its application in various contexts.

All learning outcomes are linked to the AASW Practice Standards. The student will need to demonstrate all of the above to be eligible to undertake the final placement, with an emphasis on ethical and safe skills, knowledge, and practice.

Learning outcomes for Final Placement SOWK14009:

On successful completion of this unit, you will be able to:

1. Demonstrate the integration of professional social work knowledge, skills, and values within the placement context, in alignment with the AASW Code of Ethics and AASW Practice Standards, and organisational context for practice, including adherence to legislative and policy frameworks.
2. Critically reflect on your professional practice, incorporating self-care strategies, complex problem-solving skills, and cross-cultural competency.
3. Conduct comprehensive assessments of client's needs and design, implement, and evaluate appropriate intervention strategies using social work theoretical frameworks.
4. Construct and justify a professional practice framework relevant to your social work practice and demonstrate its application in various contexts.

All learning outcomes are linked to the AASW Practice Standards and are designed to demonstrate the competence of the student as a social work graduate with explicit qualities of ethical and safe practice.

Grading of Pass/Fail for the Unit

Final recommendations for the grade to be awarded (PASS or FAIL) are essential information to be provided by the field educator. The final responsibility of the award of grades rests with the academic staff of the University. All of the procedures and processes outlined in this manual are intended to avert a situation where there is a difference of opinion about the grade to be awarded in the closing moments of field education. For this reason, all stakeholders are strongly encouraged to use the framework of the final report in supervision well before its submission. However, where there is a conflict of recommendations for grade, a thorough process of discussion and negotiation will take place in keeping with the conflict resolution processes outlined in this document.

The field education final report draws together the threads articulated throughout this manual.

- Each of the practice standards identified in the learning agreement provides the overarching framework for the final report;
- The differentiation between the focus on 'evaluation' in Field Education 1 and 'creation' in Field Education 2 reappears in the language used in that report;
- Field educators are provided with the opportunity to provide both quantitative and qualitative evaluations;

If students are not performing satisfactorily in some standards but more than satisfactorily in others, the field educator has the discretion to recommend an overall grade for the field.

Appeals

CQUni has a clear ASSESSMENT POLICY AND PROCEDURE (HIGHER EDUCATION COURSEWORK) which is available on the CQU website. You are able to request a review of a grade as per the Grades and Results Policy, and review of grades procedure – both available through the CQU website. The following shows the timeline for requesting a review.

Summary of timelines and process flows	
Process and Action	**Timeline**
Request informal consultation regarding any assessment task.	**2 working days** from the **result** being released.

Request informal consultation regarding an examination.	**2 working days** from grade certification.
Conduct of informal consultation.	**Within 5 working days** of receipt of request for informal consultation
Request to view examination script (see Assessment Policy and Procedure (Higher Education Coursework)	**2 working days** from grade certification.
Retrieval and viewing of examination script (Assessment Policy and Procedure (Higher Education Coursework).	**Within 5 working days** of request for viewing examination script
Review of Grade	
Application for review of grade.	Lodge within **10 working days** from grade certification.
Initial consideration and decision to allow/disallow review of grade.	Within **5 working days** of receipt of application for review of grades
Final outcome of review of grade that is allowed to proceed.	Within **15 working days** of receipt of application for review of grades
Challenging Outcome of Review of Grade	
Contact Student Ombudsman and submit written complaint regarding outcome of review of grade.	Within **10 working days** of notification of review of grade decision
Response to Student Complaint by Student Ombudsman	Usually within **10 working days** of the student complaint.
Challenge the outcome of the review of grade by appealing (see Academic Appeals Policy and Procedure)	Within **20 working days** of notification of decision.

Responding to Disasters

In the event of a disaster such as floods, fires, cyclones, or disease, such as another outbreak of Coronavirus, CQUni will issue bulletins on the CQUniversity website informing of the process to be followed.

If any of these situations occur while you are on placement your first contact should be your Field Educator, who may advise you to stay at home.

Please check your CQU email account for any directives from the university, and also the CQUniversity website.

Going forward CQUniversity will also be implementing other emergency notification technologies that will send emergency notifications via email, SMS, and voice messages on landline phones.

If you are unsure of whether a warning applies to your situation please seek clarification from the Field Education team or other staff members.

Feedback

We value your feedback, and it assists us in providing the information that is most useful to you on your journey.

Feedback on the Field Education Moodle site can be provided by completing the short survey on the site – on the Questions and Queries tile.

Feedback on this manual can be made by emailing the Field Education Team – fieldeducation@cqu.edu.au.

Feedback on the fieldwork experience will be invited towards the end of the term – with the big red button entitled 'Have your say' – you will receive an invitation and reminder to complete your feedback.

The CQUniversity Complaints Policy and Procedure has more information regarding informal and formal complaints, including timeframes and where to direct a complaint.



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